

Babbit	An American business man, vastly pleased with himself; of Lewis' novel Babbit
Brobdingnagian	From Swift's Gulliver's Travels, synonym for gigantic
Bumble	Mr. Bumble was the pompous Orphanage official in Oliver Twist, anyone like him.
Cinderella	Like the fairy tale girl who goes from rags to riches.
DonJuan	An unsavoury lover, the original character killed men and seduced women, any fellow who is interesting to know.
Falstaffian	Shakespeare's bawdy, good humoured fat man in his historical plays, resemblance to this character.
Frankenstein	Name of the scientist in Mary Shelley's book by the same name, who created the monster; now the monster that destroys its creator.
Friday	Robinson Crusoe's original, a helper who is dependable (man Friday)
Galahad	Noble of all knights, both good looking and gallant
Jekyll&Hyde	One who alternates between good and evil; from Stevenson's story, Hyde ends with Jekyll trapped in the murderous Hyde personality
Lilliputian	Opposite of Brobdingnagians; anything miniature or tiny
Lothario	Well known lover, character in the play 'The Fair Penitent'
Malapropism	Mrs Malaprop from Sheridan's play 'The Rivals' gained immortality by her verbal mistakes, a hilarious misuse of words
Pickwickian	Dicken's character of 'Pickwick Papers': Pickwickian words are used in an esoteric special way (not in accordance with their usual meaning)
Pooh-bah	In Gilbert and Sullivan's opera 'The Mikado' was the Lord', any politician who holds several offices is a pooh-bah
Quixotic	Don Quixote was the lovable impractical old man in Cervante's novel with the same title. Quixotic schemes are unrealistic
Robot	Czech playwright Karel Čapek's play titled R. U. R (Rossum's Universal Robots); a robot is anyone who works without thought
Scrooge	The penny-pinching miser of Christmas Carol (Dickens); now any grasping, covetous person without kindness
Simon Legree	Stowe's character in 'Uncle Tom's Cabin', the character was a slaver; anyone who works others mercilessly
Uncle Tom	In Uncle Tom's Cabin, Uncle Tom was saintly old black. Today a black who is seen as quick to co-operate with whites
Uriah Heep	From Dickens's David Copperfield, a term to describe someone hypocritical.
Walter Mitty	Thurber's lovable character from 'The Secret Life of Walter Mitty'; the embodiment of fantasies.